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AI workflow assessment, for Cint

The reconciliation cycle, redrawn

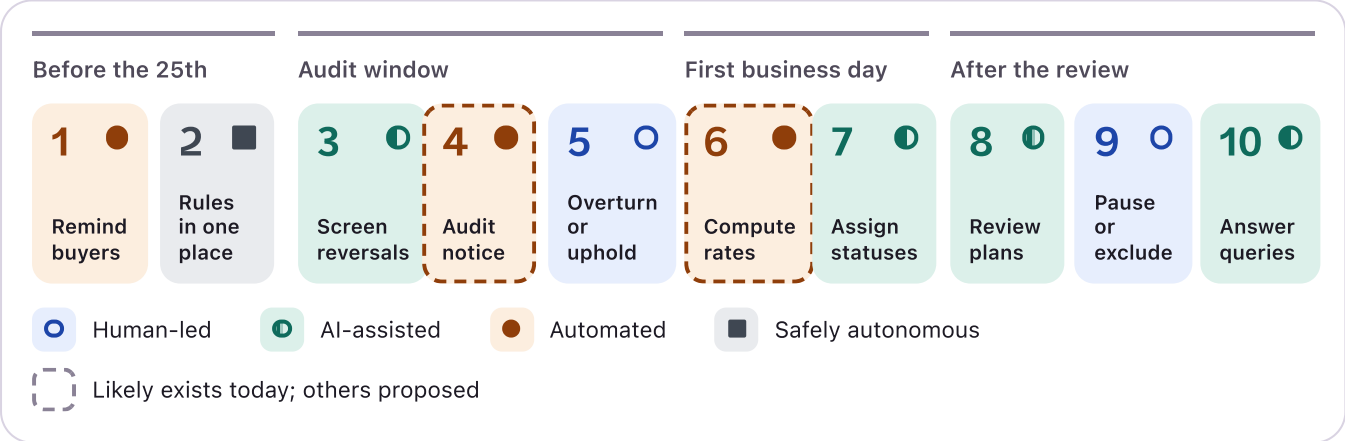
One Cint workflow, assessed from public pages as I would in my first weeks. I chose the reconciliation cycle because it is structured, measured and crosses teams; I would repeat the method with each function in the first 90 days.

> The map shows how those pages describe the work. Every sticking point is a hypothesis to test in week 1, with the people who do the work.

Seven ideas: two proceed, one reshaped, two parked, two stopped.

Ten steps: AI makes no decision of record; two that appear to work today are left alone.

A saving counts only while the appeal-overturn rate holds.



By week 2, three decisions for you: who sponsors the pilot, the baseline method, and what the DPO screen found.

First, a workflow I changed

The Cint map below uses these columns.

Zone
Who does the step. Safely autonomous: runs alone in a logged boundary, with an off switch.

Ceiling
The most AI may do there.

Decision of record
Moves money, status or rights. A person makes it.

Step	Zone	Ceiling	Gate	Measure
Design test scenarios and cases MTest Labs, a software-testing firm	AI-assisted Done	Drafts only	A tester approves every case	A full 8-hour day, or 2 to 3 days **1 to 3 supervised hours**

Staged agents draft cases from the firm's own test library and issue logs. I trained the team to run it.

Seven ideas, two proceed

Each idea is rated on value, feasibility, risk, readiness and scalability. The last is the tempting one, and it stops.

Illustrative: my ratings and decisions, from outside.

Idea	Decision	Why
The monthly reconciliation cycle	Proceed	Structured, calendar-driven and already measured.

Function
Trust and Safety Operations, supply and account teams, Finance

Ratings
Value: High Feasibility: Medium
Risk: Medium Readiness: High
Scalability: High

Public evidence
Cint reports that reversal rates on the Cint Exchange improved by about 24% from Q4 2025 to Q1 2026. The cycle runs on published codes, thresholds and a formula. Worked through in the map.

Idea	Decision	Why
One agreed source for the cycle's rules	Proceed	Cheap, low risk; needed before any assistant.

Function
Support and documentation owners

Ratings
Value: Medium Feasibility: High
Risk: Low Readiness: Medium
Scalability: High

Public evidence
Slack Enterprise Search and an AI Slackbot are live, and Cint plans to make its support assistant an agent. The cycle's rules are stated across policy, help-centre and developer pages. Links to step 2.

Collections follow-up on reconciliation adjustments

Reshape

Start from a query's evidence, not the adjustment.

Function
Finance

Ratings
Value: High Feasibility: Medium
Risk: High Readiness: Medium
Scalability: Medium

Public evidence
Collections is a stated operational priority. Reconciliations are credited on the next month's invoice. Financial controls and customer relationships are at stake, so the work starts at step 10.

Paused target-group triage and relaunch

Park

Partly automated; revisit after the first pattern.

Function
Global Coverage, Support

Ratings
Value: Medium Feasibility: Medium
Risk: Medium Readiness: Medium
Scalability: Medium

Public evidence
Auto Survey Health already pauses on defined breaches and emails the PM with suggested actions.

Data scrubbing in survey programming

Park

Personal data: DPO screen before any design.

Function
Programming and Hosting

Ratings
Value: Medium Feasibility: Medium
Risk: High Readiness: Low
Scalability: Medium

Public evidence
The work covers straight-lining, speeding and duplicates, on personal data, in line with GDPR.

Internal feasibility requests to Bidding

Stop

Refer to Product: customers already check feasibility themselves.

Function
Support, CSMs

Ratings
Value: Low Feasibility: Medium
Risk: Low Readiness: Medium
Scalability: Low

Public evidence
Human feasibility checks reach the Bidding team through a CSM or Support, and buyers already see a feasibility forecast in the Exchange. Cint's MCP integration, in closed beta, offers the same check from Claude. Redesigning the internal route would duplicate product work.

Auto-decide reversals above a confidence threshold

Stop

Each outcome moves money between buyer and supplier; a person decides.

Function
Trust and Safety Operations

Ratings
Value: High Feasibility: Medium
Risk: High Readiness: Low
Scalability: High

Public evidence
Audits review reasons and overturn late or invalid reversals. Reconciliations are credited on the buyer's next invoice. Cint evaluates RISP appeals case by case, and POP pauses follow published grace periods. Cint's managed services terms rely on the Reconciliation Policy to define unacceptable completes and the buyer's duty to report them.

Why it stays stopped
A better model does not reopen this: the constraint is accountability, not accuracy. The evidence pack in step 3 speeds the decision; it does not make it.

Beyond this workflow: four first-wave candidates

Illustrative: my outside assessment from public pages; each needs its own week-1 test with the function. Route uses the Office's three pathways: Enable, Guide and Co-build.

Function and workflow	Public signal	Ratings	Route
Sales: quote approvals and pricing checks	Cint plans internal agents to improve pricing accuracy and streamline approvals, on Sales Cloud with a custom CPQ engine.	Value: High Feasibility: Medium Risk: Medium Readiness: Medium Scalability: High	Co-build, inside Business Technology's agent plan rather than beside it.
Customer success: account review preparation	A CSM Canvas is next, bringing revenue, contract health and open escalations into one view.	Value: Medium Feasibility: High Risk: Low Readiness: Low Scalability: High	Enable: redesign the preparation around the Canvas once it lands.
Operations: project handoffs in Global Coverage	Global Coverage managers coordinate Sales, Account Management, Product and Finance, in Excel, Power BI, Salesforce and Qualtrics.	Value: Medium Feasibility: Medium Risk: Low Readiness: Medium Scalability: Medium	Guide first; co-build if the same handoff repeats across projects.
Media measurement: client reporting	The client success advert lists AI tools and MCP integrations for internal workflows as a preferred skill.	Value: Medium Feasibility: Medium Risk: Medium Readiness: Medium Scalability: Medium	Enable: a shared pattern the team already wants, with the Enablement Lead.

Decide what stays human, then place every other step

Several teams on one published calendar, codes and formula. Each row opens to its hypothesis and week-1 test.

AI makes no decision of record anywhere in this cycle.

Step		Zone	Ceiling	Gate	Measure
Before the 25th					
1	**Remind buyers before the deadline**	● Automated	Template only	None	Reconciled on time

Hypothesis
Some eligible target groups reach the deadline without anyone having looked.

Week-1 test
Count last month's target groups still open in the final week before the deadline.

If wrong
If almost none are late, drop the step.

Today
PMs see target groups eligible this month and next in the "eligible to submit" tab; the deadline is the 25th of the month after each RID's timestamp.

Ceiling in full
Rules send a reminder from an approved template to the PM and the CSM; no model; cannot change eligibility, dates or amounts.

Owner and partners
CSMs and account managers. Business Technology builds it on the Slack and Salesforce layer Cint has described.

2	**Keep each cycle rule stated once**	■ Safely autonomous	Opens tickets; edits nothing; logged	InfoSec	Open conflicts

Hypothesis
The rules sit on more pages than anyone owns, so an assistant answering from them would inherit any difference.

Week-1 test
List every page that states the deadline, the codes or the thresholds, and compare them.

If wrong
If they agree and one owner holds them, a quarterly review is enough; drop the check.

Today
The deadline, the reason codes and the programme thresholds are stated across policy, help-centre and developer pages.

Ceiling in full
A nightly check reads published pages and opens a ticket for the content owner when two disagree; it may not edit or publish anything; every run is logged; the owner can switch it off.

Owner and partners
Support and documentation owners. InfoSec reviews the check once; Business Technology builds it. Links to the second idea in the cut.

	Buyers correct rejected files (out of scope)	Product's	Load passed to Product		

Today
A failed file cannot be corrected mid-upload; the buyer downloads the error report, fixes the original and starts again.

Decision
Validation is a product feature that already checks formats and reasons. Not the Office's to redesign; the Office passes the support load this creates to Product as evidence.

Owner
The buyer, in the product.

Audit window

3	**Screen flagged reversals**	◐ AI-assisted ◆ Escalates	Drafts a pack; decides nothing	DPO, InfoSec	Minutes per screen; appeal overturns

Hypothesis
Gathering the evidence takes longer than judging it.

Week-1 test
Time three screens with an analyst, split into gathering and judging.

If wrong
If most of the time is judgement, reshape the step: a checklist rather than a pack.

Today
Cint validates every reversal submitted with a reason, and specialists run manual investigations for part of the work. Acceptable reasons include Straight-lining (932) and Speeder (933); survey-side errors such as wrong qualifications or quotas (942) are not acceptable.

Escalates to
The Trust and Safety lead, when a pattern suggests a coordinated fraud source.

Ceiling in full
Drafts an evidence pack and a reviewer note; no decision, no message, no status change. The gates section shows the output, and the build pack (https://growthforge.github.io/applications/cint-workflow-assessment/pack/) runs it.

Owner and partners
Trust and Safety Operations. DPO and InfoSec gate it; AI/Data Architecture and Business Technology build it; the Enablement Lead trains analysts on it.

4	**Send the audit notice and form**	Automated Likely exists today	Leave as is	None	Forms back in time

Hypothesis
This appears to work; the wait on the buyer's form is the right wait.

Week-1 test
Confirm how the notice goes out on the Exchange, and how many forms came back after their deadline last quarter.

If wrong
If the notice is sent by hand, automate it; if late forms are common, add one reminder; otherwise leave as is.

Today
When a reconciliation is audited, the PM is notified with a time frame to respond, and Cint's audit and final approval may run to the last calendar day of the month. The Marketplace help page describes the email as auto-generated, with the survey number, the RIDs and a form with a deadline.

Owner
Trust and Safety Operations.

5	**Overturn or uphold the reversal**	Human-led Escalates	Side-by-side view only	DPO; decision of record	Appeal overturns; time to proficiency

Hypothesis
The decision waits on finding the supplier's context, not on weighing it.

Week-1 test
Sit with two analysts on live decisions and note where the waiting happens.

If wrong
If the context is already to hand, drop the side-by-side view.

Today
Reasons are reviewed, and late or invalid reversals are overturned.

Ceiling in full
AI places the buyer's form and the supplier context side by side and makes no recommendation; the analyst decides and records the reason.

Kept human on purpose
For analysts in their first months, the side-by-side view opens only after they have recorded their own view, so they still build the judgement.

Owner and partners
Trust and Safety Operations. The DPO screens the use of buyer forms; CSMs and account managers take escalations; the Enablement Lead supports new analysts.

Escalates to
The account lead, for disputed high-value cases.

First business day

6	**Compute rates against thresholds**	Automated Likely exists today	Rules, no model	None	Negative Reconciliation Rate

Hypothesis
This appears to be automated already: rules and a published formula, with no judgement in it.

Week-1 test
Ask the reviewers whether anything is recalculated by hand before the first business day.

If wrong
Fix the data feed, still with no model. A model would add risk and no value here.

Today
RISP reviews hard-close rates and POP compares per-country soft-close rates with a 5% standard, using a published formula, on the first business day of each month. Suppliers already see the same rates in their reports and dashboards.

Owners
Trust and Safety Operations and the supply team.

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7 **Assign statuses, write the root cause** — AI-assisted — Drafts; thresholds set the status — Legal template — Minutes per status

Hypothesis
The first business day is a peak because every review lands at once, and the root-cause write-up is its slowest part.

Week-1 test
Ask reviewers to log minutes per status for one review day.

If wrong
If the write-up is quick, the draft is not worth a Legal template; drop it.

Today
Statuses follow published thresholds: for POP, Watchlist from 5% to under 10%, Needs Attention from 10% to under 40%, Alarming at 40% or more. RISP notices go out in a fixed sequence with the CSM and account manager copied, and buyers are expected to run a root-cause analysis and an action plan with their CSM.

Ceiling in full
Drafts the root-cause summary by supplier, country and source from that month's packs; the status comes from the published thresholds, never from the model; a person approves every notice before it is sent.

Owners and partners
Trust and Safety Operations (RISP) and the supply team (POP). Legal approves the template once; CSMs and account managers; the Enablement Lead.

After the review

8 **Review supplier plans of action** — AI-assisted — Flags gaps; drafts only — DPO — Days to agreed plan

Hypothesis
Plans are checked against the supplier's reversals by hand, and gaps are found late.

Week-1 test
Review five recent plans with the supply team: how long each took to check, and how many came back.

If wrong
If plans are checked quickly and rarely come back, drop the step.

Today
Suppliers in Needs Attention fill out a plan of action and review their security and quality audit form; the supply team gathers context from the buy-side team, and buyer error leads to a Retrospective Exclusion.

Ceiling in full
Compares each plan with the drivers in that supplier's reversals, flags gaps and assembles the buyer-error evidence; drafts only; reuses the step 3 integration and log.

Owner and partners
The supply and buy-side teams. The DPO; the Enablement Lead.

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9 **Pause, suspend or exclude** — Human-led — Escalates — No AI recommendation — Decision of record — Decisions inside published windows

Hypothesis
Delays come from gathering approvals, not from the rules.

Week-1 test
Trace three recent pauses from status to decision against the published windows.

If wrong
If decisions already land inside the windows, leave the step alone.

Today
POP pauses a supplier's traffic after 10 business days in Needs Attention or 2 in Alarming, unless the supplier acts within that window. RISP gives buyers two calendar months to improve before a possible suspension.

Escalates to
At Multiple Strikes L2, the contract is reviewed with the supply team.

Ceiling in full
A person makes every decision that affects a supplier's revenue or a buyer's rights; AI gives no recommendation of record.

Owners
The supply team and Trust and Safety Operations.

10	**Answer adjustment and payout queries**	AI-assisted	Drafts replies; posts nothing	Legal template, InfoSec	Days to answer; reopened queries

Hypothesis
Most of a query's handling time goes on tracing adjustment lines back to RIDs.

Week-1 test
Time three recent queries with Finance.

If wrong
If the time goes on the conversation rather than the tracing, reshape to an approved reply template only.

Today
Buyers are billed monthly on total completes, with reconciliations credited on the next month's invoice. Reconciliation adjustments are not returned through the supplier API. The total of reconciliation-eligible costs is shown in USD only.

Ceiling in full
Traces the adjustment lines on a query back to the RIDs and drafts the reply; Finance approves material adjustments and every reply; posting stays system-driven; no posting, no credit and no reply sent without approval.

Owner and partners
Finance. Legal approves the reply template; InfoSec reviews the integration; AI/Data Architecture and Business Technology build it; CSMs and account managers; the Enablement Lead.

Partners by step

I would not own these teams or systems. The grid proposes who decides each step, who gates it and who builds or supports it.

D decides or owns G gates, once B builds S supports

Partner	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Trust and Safety Operations			D	D	D	D	D		D	
Supply and buy-side teams						D	D	D	D	
CSMs and account managers	D				S		S			S
Support and documentation owners		D								
Finance										D
Legal							G			G
DPO			G		G			G		
InfoSec		G	G							G
Business Technology	B	B	B							B
AI/Data Architecture			B							B
Enablement Lead			S		S		S	S		S

The Director and the Steering Group approve any rise in a ceiling.

Gates sized to the step

DPO	Steps using buyer forms or respondent data as evidence.
InfoSec	Each new integration or autonomous check, once.
Legal	One template for AI-drafted text a customer sees.
A person	Every decision that moves money or rights.
Steering Group	Any rise in a ceiling, on evidence.

What the evidence pack returns (step 3)

Illustrative data: synthetic reversals.

Reversal A: Speeder (933), 40 completes

AI-assisted

Code: on the published acceptable list.
Reconciliation Policy

Completion times: 34 of 40 finished in under a third of the target group's median.
Completion log

Set-up: unchanged since launch.
Target-group history

Reading: consistent with the stated reason. Confidence: high. The analyst decides.

Reversal B: Speeder (933), 40 completes

AI-assisted

Completion times recorded for 9 of 40.
Completion log

Reading: not enough evidence; the analyst requests the buyer's evidence.

Build and control

Trigger	A reversal flagged for screening in the existing queue.
Reads	The reason code and RIDs, a completion-time summary, the target group's set-up history, the supplier's recent rates. Open-ended answers only if the DPO screen allows; minimised otherwise.
Writes	An evidence pack and a draft reviewer note. Nothing else.
Output contract	Every claim carries its source; confidence is stated; "not enough evidence" is a valid answer; the code check uses the published list, not the model's memory.
Gate	The analyst decides. Nothing reaches a buyer without an explicit approval.
Log	Every pack, every edit and every decision, so edits become feedback.
Stop rule	Switch off and fall back to today's manual route if the appeal-overturn rate rises above its baseline in any cycle.
Ceiling	AI-assisted. Any change goes to the Steering Group with evidence.

Reuse	Steps 7 and 8 use the same integration and log.
Route	The build, buy or configure choice is made with AI/Data Architecture, and Business Technology delivers and supports it on the Slack and Salesforce layer Cint has described, where Enterprise Search and an AI Slackbot are already live.
Tooling	For the prototype I would use whatever the architecture team approves. I have built workflows in n8n for over a year and build with Claude, Gemini and GPT, so the tool is the smaller decision.

Step 3 is built and runs offline: prompt contract, schema, eight synthetic cases, an n8n workflow with the analyst's gate, and an evaluation against a mock model. The live call needs your key.

growthforge.github.io/applications/cint-workflow-assessment/pack/

Deployment, adoption and outcome, kept apart

Baseline first: self-reported savings are weak evidence.

Deployment	Screens with a complete, sourced pack.
Adoption	Packs opened; drafts accepted with light edits.
Outcome	Days from flag to decision; analyst hours per cycle.
Quality guard	Appeal-overturn rate at or below baseline.
People	Time to proficiency for new analysts.

A saving counts only while the guard holds, and released hours count only once someone names where they go.

Illustrative data

Screens a month	**400**
× share using the pack	**70%**
× minutes saved (20 to 8)	**12**
= hours a month	**56**

Counted: overturns held at the 4.0% baseline. At 5.0%, none.

Illustrative value tree: each link needs a baseline.

Days from flag to decision	Less time with supplier traffic paused or in dispute.

Reopened buyer queries	Credits settled once, supporting collections.
Together	The reversal-rate trend Cint reports.

Twelve weeks, then a first wave

When	What happens	Ends with
Weeks 1 to 2	Walk one month-end; run the week-1 tests; start the DPO screen	Agreed map and owners
Weeks 3 to 6	Baseline one cycle; InfoSec review; prototype with two analysts, starting from the build pack (https://growthforge.github.io/applications/cint-workflow-assessment/pack/)	Pilot, or reshape
Weeks 7 to 12	One live cycle; adoption and the guard read weekly	Proceed, reshape or stop
Months 4 to 9	Handover and runbook; record published; layers reported separately	Visible improvement, with adoption data

By week 2, three decisions for you: who sponsors the pilot, the baseline method, and what the DPO screen found.

The reusable part. A blank seven-part record, from opportunity to decision log, so the next function starts from a tested pattern.
growthforge.github.io/applications/cint-workflow-assessment/assessment-record.md

Partners by stage

- **Weeks 1 to 2:** function leads and analysts in Trust and Safety, supply and Finance.
- **Weeks 3 to 6:** DPO, InfoSec, AI/Data Architecture, the Enablement Lead.
- **Weeks 7 to 12:** Trust and Safety, Support, the Enablement Lead, with the step 2 check running in parallel.
- **Months 4 to 9:** Business Technology, Finance, the Director, and a named home for released hours: root-cause work with suppliers on Watchlist.

Elsewhere in my work

Adopted beyond my team

Bnk To The Future. Redesigned case routing, triage and escalation inside segregation of duties: ~25% faster turnaround across 100+ cases. Prepared risk-committee reporting; my templates were adopted firm-wide.

Autonomy with a boundary

Atelier di Venice. Dozens of automated workflows, enquiry to delivery; low-risk steps run alone, consequential ones wait for a person.

Reconciliation at volume

AirTM. Matched daily payment volumes against provider and bank statements; cleared a 150-case backlog in three weeks; backlog down ~30%; 95%+ service level.

Sources (28 public pages)

The calendar

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The cut

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15. Cint Help, RISP FAQ (https://help.cint.com/docs/reconciliation-improvement-suspension-program-risp-faq)

The map

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22. Cint Help, Product release notes: October 30, 2026 (https://help.cint.com/docs/product-release-notes-october-30-2026)
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Partners and gates

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25. Cint, Director, Enterprise AI Transformation (Built In London copy) (https://builtinlondon.uk/job/director-enterprise-ai-transformation/10081486)
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